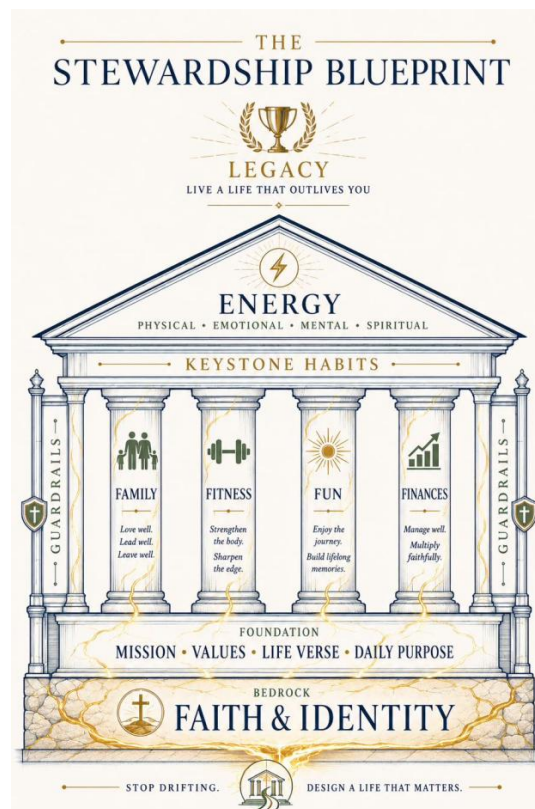


THE STEWARDSHIP BLUEPRINT

THE LIFE YOU'RE BUILDING

A 6-Week Men's Study

A journey from drift to intentional stewardship.



PARTICIPANT STUDY GUIDE

Built on Purpose. Designed to Last.

Michael J. Gauthier

This Guide Belongs To

Name

Our group meets (six dates)

Location

My accountability partner

How to use this guide

Each week has two parts: pages to complete on your own before we meet, and pages we work through together in the group session. Most weeks open with a short video that introduces the week — your leader will play it or share the link. Bring this guide, a pen, and your completed reading every week. The goal is not to fill in every blank perfectly. The goal is honesty that leads to one faithful next step.

A Word Before You Begin

Welcome. I'm glad this guide is in your hands.

You may have picked this up on your own, or a friend or leader may have handed it to you. However you arrived, the invitation is the same: for the next six weeks, take an honest look at the life you are actually building — and build it more on purpose.

The Stewardship Blueprint is built around one central conviction: your life is not merely something you own. It is something entrusted to you. Your faith, relationships, body, time, opportunities, money, energy, influence, and future impact all deserve intentional stewardship.

This isn't a book you read alone and set down. It's a structure you build together with a small group of men, one layer each week, holding each other to what you say you'll do. The teaching gives you a map; the men beside you give you the resolve to follow it. You bring the honesty.

Confidentiality is the foundation.

You are free to share as much or as little as you choose, and nothing is required of you that you are not ready to share. What is said in the group stays in the group. Trust is what makes honest change possible, so guard it for one another.

You do not need to redesign your entire life in six weeks. You simply need enough honesty to see clearly, enough courage to take one faithful step, and enough humility to let other men walk with you. That's where a building a life that matters gets built.

Let's build.

— *Michael J. Gauthier*

Author, The Life You're Building | Creator of the Stewardship Blueprint

Before We Begin

What this group is

- A space for honest reflection, practical action, and prayer.
- A guided journey through faith and identity, purpose, relationships, health, joy, finances, guardrails, habits, energy, and legacy.
- A place to build real accountability — where men keep each other moving between meetings, not just during them.

What this group is not

- A performance contest, a financial sales event, or a place to impress one another.
- Professional therapy, medical care, legal advice, or individualized financial advice.
- A demand that you disclose anything you are not ready to share.

How each meeting works

Before we meet	15–20 minutes of reading and reflection on your own. Arrive ready to share one insight.
Personal check-in	A brief, honest opening round. Each man in a sentence or two.
Watch & teaching	The group watches the short weekly video together, then a brief teaching opens the layer.
Discussion	The heart of the meeting. Honest conversation around two or three questions.
This week's action	Each man names one concrete step before the next meeting.
Prayer	We close by praying for one another.

Group Covenant

For the next six weeks, I commit to:

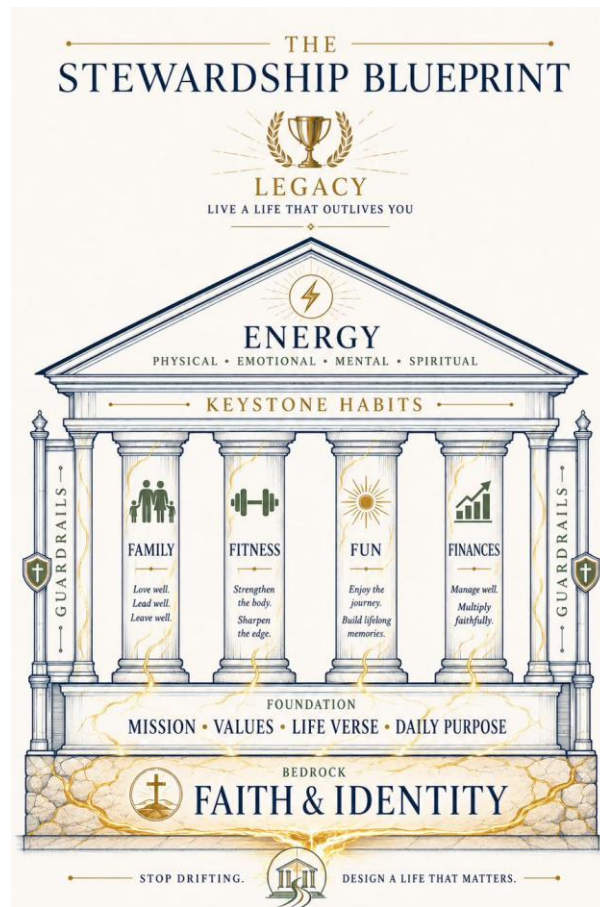
- **Show up.** Make the six weeks a real commitment, and communicate when I cannot attend.
- **Prepare.** Complete the short pre-work and arrive ready to share one insight.
- **Be honest.** Speak from my own experience rather than giving polished answers.
- **Listen well.** Ask questions before giving advice. I will not try to fix another man.
- **Respect confidentiality.** Share my own story outside the group, never another man's.
- **Allow a pass.** No one is required to answer every question.
- **Take action.** End each week with one concrete step, not only a good conversation.

Signature

Date

The Stewardship Blueprint

This image is a visual framework, not a formula for perfection. It helps us see that the different parts of life are connected — and that visible outcomes rest on deeper foundations.



Bedrock. Faith & Identity. What my life is rooted in, and where I receive worth.

Foundation. Mission, Values, Life Verse, Daily Purpose. What my life is for.

Four Pillars. Family, Fitness, Fun, Finances. The everyday areas I am called to steward.

Guardrails. Pre-decided boundaries that protect what matters before regret arrives.

Keystone Habits. Small repeated rhythms that pull the rest of life into alignment.

Energy. Physical, emotional, mental, and spiritual fuel — stewarded and renewed.

Legacy. What my life multiplies in people and causes while I am still living.

How to read the blueprint. The goal is not perfect balance. Different seasons require different emphasis. The goal is faithful alignment: no important part of the structure is ignored indefinitely, and the whole life is directed toward what matters most.

Six principles beneath the diagram

- Purpose anchors life — without it, the urgent always defeats the important.
- Faith integrates life — what I believe should shape what I decide.
- Stewardship structures life — entrusted things require intentional management.
- Guardrails protect life — drift is real, and regret is often preventable.

- Habits strengthen life — repeated faithfulness becomes the architecture of character.
- Energy sustains life — I cannot pour out forever without renewal.

The Six-Week Journey

Week 1	Wake Up	Name current reality and notice drift.
Week 2	See the Blueprint	Clarify bedrock, identity, values, mission, and daily purpose.
Week 3	Evaluate the Pillars	Assess family, fitness, fun, and finances; choose one priority.
Week 4	Install the Guardrails	Build specific boundaries that protect what matters most.
Week 5	Strengthen the Structure	Design keystone habits and steward energy.
Week 6	Design My Life	Assemble a Personal Blueprint, name a legacy, commit to 30 days.

One central question runs through all six weeks:

What kind of life am I actually building?

The Created for More Check-In

A Stewardship Blueprint Assessment

This assessment walks through the full seven-layer Blueprint, because a life is not built only on family, fitness, fun, and finances. It is built from the ground up: on what you believe, what you are building toward, the relationships and resources entrusted to you, the boundaries that protect you, the habits that shape you, the energy that fuels you, and the legacy your life is multiplying. Each layer is scored out of 20, for a total Blueprint Alignment Score out of 140.

Recommended online option. Take the Created for More Check-In at michaeljgauthier.com/created-for-more-check-in for automated scoring and progress tracking. You may also complete the assessment in this workbook and score it yourself.

Complete the BEFORE assessment before Week 1. At the end of Week 6, retake it online or complete the AFTER column. One month later, retake it online or complete the 30-DAY column. Each week of this study builds one of these layers—so you can see where progress is happening.

Rate each statement 1 to 5:

1 rarely true • **2** occasionally • **3** somewhat / room to grow • **4** mostly true • **5** consistently true and intentionally protected

The value is not in the score alone. It is in the honesty. A lower score after reflection does not always mean failure; sometimes greater honesty produces a more accurate rating. Compare the numbers with the changes you actually made and the stories you can tell.

Statement (rate 1–5)	Before	After	30-Day
Layer 1 — Bedrock — Faith & Identity			
<i>Is my identity rooted in something deeper than performance and pressure?</i>			
I know who I am beneath my roles, titles, and achievements.			
My daily choices flow from a settled identity, not from proving myself.			
I return to my faith as a source of stability, not just a Sunday habit.			
I can name the truth I stand on when life feels uncertain.			
Layer score	____ / 20	____ / 20	____ / 20
Layer 2 — Foundation — Mission, Values & Purpose			
<i>Am I living with clarity about what kind of life I am building?</i>			
I have clarity about what matters most in this season.			
My calendar reflects my stated priorities.			
I could state my mission and values in a sentence if asked.			
I am building my life around purpose, not just pressure or expectation.			
Layer score	____ / 20	____ / 20	____ / 20

Statement (rate 1–5)	Before	After	30-Day
Layer 3 — The Four Pillars — Family, Fitness, Fun & Finances			
<i>Are the areas I stand on every day actually able to hold weight?</i>			
The people I love are receiving my presence, not just my provision. (Family)			
My sleep, movement, and health support the life I want to build. (Fitness)			
I make room for joy, rest, and meaningful experiences — not just obligation. (Fun)			
My finances serve my purpose and values, not fear or comparison. (Finances)			
Layer score	____ / 20	____ / 20	____ / 20
Layer 4 — Guardrails — Boundaries That Protect			
<i>Do I have boundaries in place before I need them, not just after damage is done?</i>			
I have clear boundaries around my time, attention, and commitments.			
I have limits in place that protect my integrity under pressure.			
I say no to good things that would crowd out my best things.			
Someone else knows my guardrails and helps me keep them.			
Layer score	____ / 20	____ / 20	____ / 20

Four Pillars sub-score. Because each pillar statement above measures a different pillar, note each one out of 5. Your lowest pillar is a strong candidate for your Week 3 Focus Pillar.

Family	Fitness	Fun	Finances
____ / 5	____ / 5	____ / 5	____ / 5

Statement (rate 1–5)	Before	After	30-Day
Layer 5 — Keystone Habits — Rhythms That Strengthen			
<i>Do my daily habits move me toward the life I say I want?</i>			
I have identified one or two habits that, if kept, would change everything else.			
My mornings or evenings have a rhythm that supports who I am trying to become.			
When a keystone habit slips, I notice quickly and recover instead of spiraling.			
My habits are shaping my identity, not just filling my to-do list.			
Layer score	____ / 20	____ / 20	____ / 20
Layer 6 — Energy — The Resource Beneath Every Resource			
<i>Am I stewarding the energy beneath everything I do?</i>			
I know where my physical, emotional, mental, and spiritual energy actually goes.			
I have rhythms of renewal built in before I hit empty, not just after.			
I recognize the difference between being busy and being depleted.			
I am living on today's connection with God, not yesterday's.			
Layer score	____ / 20	____ / 20	____ / 20
Layer 7 — Legacy — What Your Life Multiplies			
<i>What is my life producing beyond me?</i>			
I am intentionally shaping what the next generation sees in me.			
My time, money, and influence are aligned with what I want to leave behind.			
I have had a real conversation about legacy with someone I love.			
I am building something today that will outlast me.			
Layer score	____ / 20	____ / 20	____ / 20

Score Your Check-In

Add each layer out of 20, then total all seven for your Blueprint Alignment Score out of 140. This is a mirror, not a grade — it shows where alignment is strong and where drift may be showing up.

Layer	Before	After	30-Day
1. Bedrock — Faith & Identity	___ / 20	___ / 20	___ / 20
2. Foundation — Mission, Values & Purpose	___ / 20	___ / 20	___ / 20
3. The Four Pillars	___ / 20	___ / 20	___ / 20
4. Guardrails	___ / 20	___ / 20	___ / 20
5. Keystone Habits	___ / 20	___ / 20	___ / 20
6. Energy	___ / 20	___ / 20	___ / 20
7. Legacy	___ / 20	___ / 20	___ / 20
BLUEPRINT ALIGNMENT SCORE	___ / 140	___ / 140	___ / 140

Per-layer status guide

17–20 — Strong / Protect. Healthy. Protect and strengthen what is already working.

13–16 — Stable / Strengthen. Meaningful alignment, but may need a clearer rhythm.

9–12 — Stretched / Focus. Needs attention soon, before drift becomes normal.

4–8 — Drifting / Rebuild. Should become a primary focus for your next faithful step.

Overall stage

112–140 — Aligned & Intentional. Meaningful clarity across the seven layers. The next step is protection and multiplication.

84–111 — Aware but Stretched. Real alignment in some layers, but stretched or inconsistent in others. Choose one layer to focus.

56–83 — Drifting in Key Layers. Parts of life shaped more by default than design. Start with your lowest layer and invite accountability.

Below 56 — Time to Pause & Rebuild. A season for deeper reflection and support. Begin with one honest step; don't fix everything at once.

A note on support. This is a reflection tool. If your answers reveal crisis, danger, abuse, self-harm, addiction risk, or a situation beyond the scope of this guide, please seek appropriate pastoral, clinical, emergency, legal, medical, or financial support.

My Blueprint Snapshot

Turn your score into a simple picture you can revisit. If you take the Check-In online at michaeljgauthier.com/created-for-more-check-in, your scoring and progress will be saved and tracked automatically. If you use the workbook, fill the BEFORE column now (Week 1), AFTER in Week 6, and 30-DAY one month later, then record the results below.

Snapshot item	Before (Wk 1)	After (Wk 6)	30-Day
Blueprint Alignment Score (/140)			
Current stage			
Strongest layer			
Lowest layer			
Lowest pillar (if Pillars is lowest)			
My one focus for this study			

What my lowest layer may be telling me

Use your lowest layer to find a starting point. This is a prompt for honest reflection, not a diagnosis — and it points to the week of this study that will help most.

Bedrock. Carrying too much from performance or self-reliance. Reconnect with the truth you stand on. **(Week 2)**

Foundation. Moving with responsibility but not enough clarity of mission and values. **(Week 2)**

Four Pillars. One everyday area is carrying more strain than the structure can sustain. **(Week 3)**

Guardrails. Relying on good intentions where a clear boundary is needed before regret. **(Week 4)**

Keystone Habits. Not yet enough repeated rhythms to make alignment sustainable. **(Week 5)**

Energy. Stewarding important things while running low on the fuel to sustain them. **(Week 5)**

Legacy. Living responsibly, but without clarity about what your life is multiplying. **(Week 6)**

WEEK 1

Wake Up

What kind of life am I building?

Read Before We Meet

Most men do not wake up and decide to neglect what matters. Drift usually happens quietly. One full week becomes a full season. One postponed conversation becomes distance. One busy month becomes a life organized around urgency. Nothing feels dramatic in the moment, yet something is being built.

Busyness can disguise drift because activity feels responsible. We answer messages, solve problems, provide, lead, and keep moving. The danger is not always laziness. The danger is motion without direction. We can be productive and still be misaligned. We can succeed according to a scoreboard that is too small.

Stewardship begins with a different assumption: my life is entrusted, not merely owned. My days, relationships, body, opportunities, resources, influence, and energy are gifts for which I carry responsibility. That does not mean I control every outcome. It means I am called to pay attention and respond faithfully.

The first step is not to fix everything. The first step is to see clearly. Psalm 90:12 (NIV) is a prayer for exactly this kind of clarity. Awareness is not condemnation. It is grace arriving before regret. It gives us the chance to notice where our stated priorities and our lived priorities have separated.

Your calendar, spending, habits, screen time, recurring thoughts, and emotional energy often tell the truth before your intentions do. This week, resist the urge to give an impressive answer. Describe the life that is actually being built. Notice what is aligned. Notice what is strained. Notice what you keep postponing.

THE BIG IDEA

Drift is subtle. Design is intentional. The life I am building is revealed by my calendar, attention, and energy — not only my intentions.

Check-In layer

Take your baseline today. Note your Blueprint Alignment Score, strongest layer, and lowest layer.

This week's outcome

Name current reality without shame and write a clear intention for the next six weeks.

Teach us to number our days, that we may gain a heart of wisdom.

— **Psalm 90:12 (NIV)**

Be very careful, then, how you live—not as unwise but as wise, making the most of every opportunity, because the days are evil.

— **Ephesians 5:15-16 (NIV)**

BEFORE WE MEET — PRE-WORK

Set aside 15–20 quiet minutes. Put your phone away. Answer from current reality, not from what you wish were true.

1. Describe your current season in one word and one sentence.

2. What five things currently receive the most of your time, energy, money, and attention?

3. Where do you feel most aligned right now? Where do you feel off track?

4. If nothing changes, where might your current patterns lead in five years?

Current Blueprint Rating (1–10)

Rate each area quickly and honestly: Bedrock, Foundation, Family, Fitness, Fun, Finances, Energy.

Bedrock	Found.	Family	Fitness	Fun	Finances	Energy

My one-sentence intention for the next six weeks is

GROUP SESSION

WATCH TOGETHER — WEEK 1 VIDEO

Your group opens the session with the short Week 1 video, “Wake Up” (about 3-4 minutes). Watch it together, or watch beforehand if your leader shares the link.

Personal check-in — the word and sentence that describe my current season:

During our discussion — signs of drift I noticed, even when things look responsible:

The greatest tension between what I say matters and where my best energy actually goes:

THIS WEEK'S ACTION

- Keep my six-week intention somewhere visible.
- Have one honest conversation with a spouse, friend, mentor, or family member about the area that needs attention.

Prayer. Ask God for the courage to see clearly, the humility to receive truth without shame, and the wisdom to take one faithful step.

Next week. We move beneath visible activity to the Bedrock and Foundation: identity, faith, values, mission, and daily purpose.

Notes

WEEK 2

See the Blueprint

Bedrock & Foundation

Read Before We Meet

A blueprint can show where the walls go, but it cannot tell you why the house is being built. That question comes first. A disciplined life can still be aimed at the wrong definition of success if the deeper foundation is never examined.

In the Stewardship Blueprint, Bedrock is faith and identity. It asks: What is my life rooted in? Where do I receive worth? What remains true when performance changes, people are disappointed, or plans fall apart? If identity is built on approval, achievement, money, control, or image, pressure will eventually expose the weakness. For a follower of Jesus, identity is received before it is achieved. We work from worth, not for worth.

Faith is not one room in the house. It is the integrating center of the whole structure. It should shape how we love, lead, work, spend, rest, respond, and define success. Compartmentalized faith says, “I believe.” Integrated faith asks, “What is that belief producing in my actual life?”

Foundation answers a second question: What is my life for? In this guide it has four parts. Mission names the assignment or contribution that matters in this season. Values are priorities you are willing to protect with your calendar, money, and decisions. A life verse or guiding Scripture gives language to the truth you want to remember. Daily purpose translates the big picture into the way you want to show up today.

These statements do not need to be perfect. A rough, honest mission is more useful than a polished sentence that does not move you. Values are not words you admire; they are filters that help you say yes and no. Identity comes before strategy. When bedrock and foundation become clearer, choices do not always become easy, but they become more aligned.

THE BIG IDEA

Identity before strategy. When I know who I am and what my life is for, every open door stops looking like my door.

Check-In layer

Layers 1 & 2 — Bedrock and Foundation. Review those two scores as you work this week.

This week's outcome

A first-draft Bedrock and Foundation: identity, mission, values, life verse, and daily purpose.

Therefore everyone who hears these words of mine and puts them into practice is like a wise man who built his house on the rock. The rain came down, the streams rose, and the winds blew and beat against that house; yet it did not fall, because it had its foundation on the rock.

— **Matthew 7:24-25 (NIV)**

Above all else, guard your heart, for everything you do flows from it.

— **Proverbs 4:23 (NIV)**

BEFORE WE MEET — PRE-WORK

Create a first draft. Do not wait for perfect language. You will refine these in Week 6.

Values bank

Circle the eight that matter most, then narrow to five.

Faith • Integrity • Family • Presence • Generosity • Health • Courage • Discipline • Humility
• Excellence • Freedom • Service • Wisdom • Faithfulness • Adventure • Gratitude •
Stewardship • Patience • Loyalty • Growth • _____ • _____

5. Bedrock. Where do you most often look for worth — and what remains true about you when performance changes?

-
6. My top five values:

-
7. My one-sentence mission (draft). “To _____ so that _____.”

-
8. My life verse or guiding Scripture:

-
9. My daily purpose — a short phrase for how I want to show up today:

GROUP SESSION

WATCH TOGETHER — WEEK 2 VIDEO

Open the session with the Week 2 video, “See the Blueprint” (about 3-5 minutes).

Personal check-in — one value or sentence I want to carry into this season:

During our discussion — where my identity has been borrowed from performance, approval, or image:

What would change if I lived from mission and values instead of reaction or approval:

THIS WEEK’S ACTION

- Refine my mission to one or two sentences.
- Choose one daily reminder practice: morning prayer, a verse card, a journal, a calendar prompt, or phone wallpaper.

Prayer. Ask God to separate your identity from performance and to clarify the people, responsibilities, and purpose entrusted to you.

Next week. We evaluate the four visible pillars: Family, Fitness, Fun, and Finances. The goal is not perfect balance; it is honest stewardship.

Notes

WEEK 3

Evaluate the Pillars

Family, Fitness, Fun & Finances

Read Before We Meet

The four pillars represent everyday areas of responsibility that support the life we are building. They are connected, and each carries weight.

Family includes marriage, parenting, friendship, mentoring, and community — the people entrusted to our relational influence. It asks whether the people closest to us receive intentional presence or only what remains after work and responsibility.

Fitness is the stewardship of the body that carries the calling: movement, strength, sleep, nutrition, recovery, medical wisdom, and the physical capacity to love, serve, work, and enjoy life. Health is not ultimate, but neglect in the body eventually affects patience, energy, relationships, finances, and opportunities.

Fun includes joy, rest, adventure, celebration, play, Sabbath, and meaningful experiences. It is not shallow escape. It is the intentional reception of life-giving gifts that renew the soul and create memory. Responsible men often postpone joy until life slows down; life rarely slows down on its own.

Finances include earning, spending, saving, giving, planning, freedom, provision, and impact. Money is a powerful tool but a poor identity. It often reveals what we trust, fear, value, and prioritize. Financial stewardship is not only about having more; it is about aligning resources with purpose.

The goal is not equal time in all four areas every week. Seasons change. The danger comes when temporary imbalance becomes permanent neglect. This week, evaluate without exaggerating and without minimizing. Name one win and one concern in each pillar. Then choose the one pillar that most needs a focused next step. Strengthening one load-bearing area can create a positive ripple through the whole structure.

THE BIG IDEA

The goal is not perfect balance. It is faithful stewardship — making sure no load-bearing pillar is neglected indefinitely.

Check-In layer

Layer 3 — The Four Pillars. Your lowest pillar sub-score points to your Focus Pillar.

This week's outcome

An honest read of all four pillars and one priority pillar chosen for the next 90 days.

Whoever can be trusted with very little can also be trusted with much, and whoever is dishonest with very little will also be dishonest with much.

— **Luke 16:10 (NIV)**

Anyone who does not provide for their relatives, and especially for their own household, has denied the faith and is worse than an unbeliever.

— **1 Timothy 5:8 (NIV)**

BEFORE WE MEET — PRE-WORK

Use evidence from your calendar, habits, relationships, health, and spending. Avoid both shame and vague optimism. Score each pillar 1–10 and name one win and one concern.

Start with your Check-In. Bring your four pillar sub-scores (out of 5) from the Created for More Check-In. Your lowest one is the strongest signal for the Focus Pillar you'll rebuild over the next 90 days — confirm or challenge it with the deeper read below.

Pillar	Honest question	/10	One win / one concern
Family	Are the people closest to me getting my presence — or my leftovers?	—	
Fitness	Is my health building capacity — or quietly eroding it?	—	
Fun	Is there room for joy and rest — or only responsibility?	—	
Finances	Is money serving my purpose — or shaping my identity?	—	

The pillar that most needs attention over the next 90 days is

GROUP SESSION

WATCH TOGETHER — WEEK 3 VIDEO

Open the session with the Week 3 video, “Evaluate the Pillars” (about 3-5 minutes).

Personal check-in — one current win in any pillar:

During our discussion — how strength or neglect in one pillar is affecting the rest of my life:

My priority pillar, and the first seven-day step:

THIS WEEK'S ACTION

- Choose one priority pillar for the next 90 days.
- Take one visible step this week, and tell one person what you are doing.

Prayer. Thank God for what is healthy, ask for honesty about what is strained, and pray for wisdom to strengthen one pillar without trying to control everything.

Next week. We build Guardrails: specific boundaries that protect the people, priorities, and freedoms we say matter most.

Notes

WEEK 4

Install the Guardrails

Protect what matters

Read Before We Meet

Roadside guardrails are not placed in the middle of the danger. They are placed before it. They do not prevent every collision, but they keep a moment of drift from becoming a catastrophe.

Personal guardrails work the same way. They are pre-decided standards or boundaries that keep us away from places where wisdom becomes harder and regret becomes more likely. Good intentions are not guardrails. “I should be more careful” is not specific enough to protect anything under pressure.

Guardrails may be needed around time, technology, money, relationships, sexuality, work, alcohol, health, travel, emotional reactions, or spiritual life. The right guardrail is personal because the danger zone is personal. A boundary that is unnecessary for one man may be wise for another.

Guardrails are not a sign of weakness. They are a form of stewardship. They protect freedom, trust, energy, and future options. A work cutoff can protect marriage and sleep. A spending rule can protect generosity and peace. A technology boundary can protect attention. A health guardrail can keep one difficult week from becoming a destructive season.

A useful guardrail has four parts. First, name what matters — what are you protecting? Second, name the danger or trigger — when are you most likely to drift? Third, make the boundary concrete — what will you do or not do? Fourth, tell someone — accountability makes the decision real before pressure arrives. Wise boundaries and honest heart work belong together; ask what desire, fear, resentment, comparison, or need for approval is underneath the behavior.

THE BIG IDEA

A guardrail is a decision made before the moment of pressure. It is not restriction for its own sake — it protects something I do not want to lose.

Check-In layer

Layer 4 — Guardrails. A low score here is exactly what this week is built to raise.

This week's outcome

One specific, measurable guardrail — written down and shared with one trusted person.

The prudent see danger and take refuge, but the simple keep going and pay the penalty.

— **Proverbs 27:12 (NIV)**

So, if you think you are standing firm, be careful that you don't fall!

— **1 Corinthians 10:12 (NIV)**

BEFORE WE MEET — PRE-WORK

Look for places where consequences are predictable, temptation is recurring, or the cost of drift would be high.

10. Where are you most vulnerable to drift right now? Name two or three areas.

11. Recall a regret — yours or one you watched up close — that a guardrail set earlier might have prevented.

12. Draft one guardrail using the four parts: what it protects, the trigger, the specific boundary, and who you'll tell.

Guardrail design test

- Is it specific enough that I will know whether I kept it?
- Does it begin before the danger zone rather than inside it?
- Does it protect something I deeply value?
- Have I told someone who can ask me about it?

GROUP SESSION

WATCH TOGETHER — WEEK 4 VIDEO

Open the session with the Week 4 video, “Install the Guardrails” (about 3-5 minutes).

Personal check-in — a predictable danger zone where I need a stronger boundary:

During our discussion — why capable men resist boundaries, even when the risk is obvious:

My one guardrail, made measurable — what I'll do, when it begins, and who will know:

THIS WEEK'S ACTION

- Put one guardrail in writing and begin it this week.
- Tell one trusted person and ask him to check in with you.

Prayer. Pray for humility to accept limits, courage to name the real danger, and strength to protect what has been entrusted.

Next week. We move from protection to reinforcement: the keystone habits and energy rhythms that make faithful living sustainable.

Notes

WEEK 5

Strengthen the Structure

Keystone Habits & Energy

Read Before We Meet

Guardrails keep us away from predictable danger. Habits help us move repeatedly toward what matters. The life we build will be shaped less by occasional inspiration than by recurring rhythms.

A keystone habit is a small routine that creates a larger ripple. A morning walk may improve sleep, mood, food choices, prayer, and patience. A weekly planning conversation may improve marriage, family logistics, money, and rest. A phone-free dinner may strengthen attention, conversation, and family culture. The best habit is not the most impressive one. It is the one that is aligned, repeatable, and likely to strengthen several parts of the blueprint.

Start with identity: What kind of man am I becoming? Then choose a behavior that proves that identity in a small way. Make the habit specific — name the cue, the minimum version, the normal version, the environment, and how you will track it. A minimum version protects continuity on hard days. Missing once is information; allowing one miss to become a new pattern is the danger. Recovery is part of the system.

Habits require energy, and energy must also be stewarded. Physical energy supports strength and endurance. Emotional energy shapes the tone we bring to relationships. Mental energy affects attention, judgment, and creativity. Spiritual energy connects us to God, identity, hope, and purpose.

Energy is renewable, but not unlimited. Healthy life has a pulse: investment and renewal, exertion and recovery, work and Sabbath. Continuous output without renewal becomes debt. This week, notice what drains and restores you. Some draining responsibilities cannot be removed, but they can be redesigned, shared, bounded, or followed by renewal. Choose one keystone habit and one renewal rhythm — small enough to practice and clear enough to measure.

THE BIG IDEA

I am shaped less by occasional inspiration than by recurring rhythms. One keystone habit, and one rhythm of renewal, can strengthen the whole structure.

Check-In layer

Layers 5 & 6 — Keystone Habits and Energy. Both are measured; both are built this week.

This week's outcome

One keystone habit designed and started, and one renewal rhythm protected for seven days.

Let us not become weary in doing good, for at the proper time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.

— **Galatians 6:9 (NIV)**

Then, because so many people were coming and going that they did not even have a chance to eat, he said to them, "Come with me by yourselves to a quiet place and get some rest."

— **Mark 6:31 (NIV)**

BEFORE WE MEET — PRE-WORK

Use the snapshot below. The point is not perfect data; it is awareness of patterns.

Energy snapshot — what drains and what renews

Energy type	Renews me	Drains me
Physical <i>sleep, movement, nutrition, recovery</i>		
Emotional <i>the tone I bring into relationships</i>		
Mental <i>focus, clarity, attention</i>		
Spiritual <i>connection to God, purpose, peace</i>		

Design one keystone habit

Identity — I am becoming the kind of man who

The habit (small + specific)

The cue (after I... / time + place)

Minimum version on a hard day

One renewal rhythm I will protect

GROUP SESSION

WATCH TOGETHER — WEEK 5 VIDEO

Open the session with the Week 5 video, “Strengthen the Structure” (about 3-5 minutes).

Personal check-in — a habit or energy pattern that’s been on my mind:

During our discussion — where my energy is leaking, and what one keystone habit would create the greatest ripple:

The rhythm I need to start, stop, reduce, or protect:

THIS WEEK'S ACTION

- Practice one keystone habit for seven days using the design you created.
- Protect one energy-renewing rhythm — and treat it as stewardship, not leftover time.

Prayer. Ask God for discipline without pride, rest without guilt, and renewed strength to invest in what matters most.

Next week. We bring the whole framework together into a Personal Blueprint, a legacy statement, and a 30-day commitment.

Notes

WEEK 6

Design My Life

Personal Blueprint & Legacy

Read Before We Meet

A blueprint is valuable only if it guides the building. Insight without action can become another form of delay. The purpose of these six weeks is not to produce a perfect document. It is to create enough clarity to live differently.

Your Personal Blueprint brings the parts together. Bedrock names the faith and identity from which you want to live. Foundation names mission, values, Scripture, and daily purpose. The pillars reveal where attention is needed. Guardrails protect what matters. Keystone habits create repeated alignment. An energy plan helps sustain the work. Legacy names what you want your life to multiply in people and causes.

Legacy is not only what is left after death. It is what other people experience from your life now. It is the culture of your home, the character you model, the stories you tell, the people you mentor, the generosity you practice, the courage you lend, and the faith you pass forward. Financial inheritance may be part of legacy, but relational and spiritual formation begin much earlier.

Your Blueprint should be specific enough to guide a decision and flexible enough to grow with your season. It is a living document, not a contract with perfection. Choose a 30-day commitment — long enough to create evidence and short enough to feel real. Decide what you will start, stop, continue, protect, and discuss. Choose an accountability person and a review date. Then share the Blueprint with someone close to you.

The most important outcome is not the page you complete. It is the man you are becoming and the life other people experience because you chose to stop drifting. Build with humility. Review with honesty. Begin with one faithful next step.

THE BIG IDEA

The most important outcome is not the page I complete. It is the man I am becoming — and the life others experience because I chose to stop drifting.

Check-In layer

Layer 7 — Legacy. Then retake all seven layers and compare your Alignment Score.

This week's outcome

A completed Personal Blueprint, a legacy statement, and a written 30-day commitment.

But if serving the Lord seems undesirable to you, then choose for yourselves this day whom you will serve, whether the gods your ancestors served beyond the Euphrates, or the gods of the Amorites, in whose land you are living. But as for me and my household, we will serve the Lord.

— **Joshua 24:15 (NIV)**

And the things you have heard me say in the presence of many witnesses entrust to reliable people who will also be qualified to teach others.

— **2 Timothy 2:2 (NIV)**

BEFORE WE MEET — PRE-WORK

Review your notes from Weeks 1–5 and complete a first draft of the Personal Blueprint pages (next section) before our final meeting. Come ready for a three-minute share: what woke me up, what I am choosing, and my next 30-day step.

GROUP SESSION

WATCH TOGETHER — WEEK 6 VIDEO

Open the session with the Week 6 video, “Design My Life” (about 3–5 minutes).

Personal check-in — in one sentence, what changed most over these six weeks:

During our discussion — what my Blueprint says about the man I want to become and the life I want others to experience:

My next faithful step for the next 30 days, and who will help me keep it:

THIS WEEK’S ACTION

- Share your Personal Blueprint with a spouse, friend, mentor, or accountability partner.
- Schedule a 30-day check-in and a 90-day Blueprint review.

Prayer. Thank God for what became clear, surrender what remains unfinished, and ask for faithfulness in the next step rather than pressure to control the entire future.

My Personal Blueprint

Use these pages to create a working Blueprint for this season. Keep the language clear and practical. The goal is not to predict every detail of the future. The goal is to make your next decisions from a wiser structure. Review it at 30 and 90 days; update it when your season changes, but do not change it simply because a commitment becomes uncomfortable.

1. Bedrock — Faith & Identity

What my life is rooted in, and where I receive worth.

2. Foundation

Mission, top values, life verse, and daily purpose.

3. The Four Pillars

One sentence on each: Family, Fitness, Fun, Finances — and my priority pillar.

4. My Guardrails

The boundaries I am choosing, and what each one protects.

5. My Keystone Habit

The small rhythm that strengthens the most, with its cue and minimum version.

6. My Energy Plan

What renews me, what drains me, and the rhythm I will protect.

7. My Legacy

What I want my life to multiply in people and causes, starting now.

8. My 30-Day Commitments

Start	<i>What I will begin</i>
Stop	<i>What I will end</i>
Continue	<i>What is working</i>
Protect	<i>What I will guard</i>
Conversation	<i>Who I will talk with</i>
Accountability	<i>Who will check in + review date</i>

Final Reflection

Six weeks ago you began looking honestly at the life you were building. Before you close this guide, take time to name what has changed — and to make sure the next step is clear.

First: complete the AFTER column

Retake the Created for More Check-In online using the link near the front of this guide, or complete the AFTER column in the workbook. Record your updated Blueprint Alignment Score, note which layers moved most, and update your Blueprint Snapshot.

Look back

13. What resonated most over these six weeks — and why?

14. What specific change did you make, or set in motion?

15. Which week, verse, exercise, or question affected you most?

16. Where did your Blueprint Alignment Score move most — and what does that tell you?

17. Who in your life is the ideal man to walk through this next?

Before your 30-day check-in

- Practice your 30-day commitment.
- Keep your Blueprint visible.
- Notice what becomes easier, what resists change, and who notices a difference.
- Retake the Check-In online or complete the 30-DAY column in the workbook, then update your Blueprint Snapshot.

Keep Building — Choose Your Next Step

These six weeks are a beginning, not a finish line. Your next step should match your season. Pick the path — or paths — that will help you keep building.

WATCH — WHAT'S NEXT

Close out the study with the short “What’s Next” video (about 4 minutes) — your leader will share the link, or find it at MichaelJGauthier.com.

Run a personal 30-day plan. Choose one layer, one action, one conversation, and one rhythm. Retake the Check-In in 30 days.

Keep going with this group. Stay connected for accountability, and complete your 30-day and 90-day Blueprint reviews together.

Lead or host the next group. If your score is strong and no layer is in rebuild, consider leading the next six-week group. The Leader Guide gives you everything you need.

Live it daily in ForgedLife. App-based accountability — habits, challenges, prayer, and group follow-through built around the Blueprint. Visit theforged.life.

Read The Life You’re Building. Go deeper into the full framework through story, Scripture, reflection, and practical action. Join the updates list at MichaelJGauthier.com.

Bring it to your church. If you help lead a men’s ministry or small-group program, explore running the Stewardship Blueprint with your people at MichaelJGauthier.com.

You were not created merely to keep up. You were created to steward a life that matters.

— The Stewardship Blueprint

Scripture quotations taken from *The Holy Bible, New International Version® (NIV®)*. Copyright © 1973, 1978, 1984, 2011 by Biblica, Inc.® Used by permission. All rights reserved worldwide.

© Michael J. Gauthier • The Stewardship Blueprint. Educational and spiritual content only; not medical, mental-health, legal, tax, or individualized financial advice.